

Christina Chance

Community-Informed NLP · Algorithmic Fairness & Ethics

christinachance315@gmail.com · <https://christinachance.github.io/> · Google Scholar

EDUCATION

University of California at Los Angeles

2022 – Present

Ph.D. in Computer Science (M.S. awarded 2025)

Eugene V. Cota-Robles Fellow, GEM Fellow.

Advisor: Prof. Kai-Wei Chang

Dissertation Title: Whose Ground Truth? Diagnosing Where Language Technologies Fail the Communities They Act On

Emory University

2018 – 2022

B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics, minor in Physics

Magna Cum Laude.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research asks **whose norms language technologies encode**, and what happens when those norms are imposed on people whose language and lived experiences fall outside them. These systems fail in patterned ways: **flattening legitimate disagreement**, **misreading dialect as hostility**, and **importing historical bias** into settings that can least absorb it. I audit these failures and develop methods to make social and linguistic variation **visible, measurable, and consequential to system design**. Looking forward, I ask whether language technologies can support **cultural pluralism**. I am interested in building modeling frameworks and tools that learn from community disagreement and adapt to dialect and identity variation, so that systems reflect the norms of the communities they serve rather than a single default.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher

Los Angeles, CA

University of California Los Angeles | UCLA Natural Language Processing Lab

PI: Prof. Kai-Wei Chang

Sept. 2022 – Present

- ★ Build and release annotated corpora of dialect and reclaimed language, and fine-tune large language models to detect and classify hate speech and toxicity across Black, LGBTQIA+, and women communities.
- ★ Develop methods to characterize how content moderation and language technologies fail marginalized individuals, auditing where cultural pluralism collapses under social and linguistic variation.
- ★ Served as lab social chair for three years, planning lab retreats, dinners, and social events to build community across the group.

University of California Los Angeles | Health Equity Working Group

PIs: Prof. Vickie Mays and Prof. Susan Cochran

Sept. 2023 – Present

- ★ Applied statistical analysis and word embedding analysis to suicide death narratives in the National Violent Death Reporting System, characterizing the completeness and complexity of the records, leveraging existing APIs to process the data at scale.
- ★ Measured syntactic complexity and performed scope identification to surface where narratives are uncertain, incomplete, or missing information.

Research Intern

San Jose, CA

Adobe Research | Document Intelligence | advised by Jennifer Healey

June 2025 – Sept. 2025

- ★ Interned on the Document Intelligence team, which combines language understanding and document analysis to unlock the information inside documents. Identified recommendation skew in automated recommender systems, where certain products are never surfaced to specific demographic groups, and designed an approach to address it

- ★ Developed a probabilistic persona generation method (“surprising personas”) to increase recommendation diversity, identified patterns of preference-based bias in the context of recommendations, then evaluated and validated the method through a 977-participant survey.

University of California Los Angeles | The BioCritical Studies Lab | PI: Prof. Terence Keel

Sept. 2023 – Sept. 2025

- ★ Adapted an existing forensic autopsy annotation schema into a framework for automation, targeting deaths of incarcerated people.
- ★ Evaluated language model performance against validated data to test the feasibility of automating the annotation scheme.
- ★ Translated CS and NLP concepts for sociology and African American Studies collaborators, grounding the work in context, stakeholders, and community.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Publications

- [1] Susan D. Cochran, **Christina Chance**, Alina Arseniev-Koehler, Bruce Cuthbert, and Vickie M. Mays. “Research Domain Criteria and Deaths by Suicide in the National Violent Death Reporting System”. In: *JAMA Network Open* 9.3 (Mar. 2026), e264024–e264024. ISSN: 2574-3805. DOI: 10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2026.4024. eprint: https://jamanetwork.com/journals/jamanetworkopen/articlepdf/2847122/cochran_2026_oi_260158_1774285966.19766.pdf. URL: <https://doi.org/10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2026.4024>.
- [2] **Christina Chance**, Alina Arseniev-Koehler, Vickie M. Mays, Kai-Wei Chang, and Susan D. Cochran. “Measuring Narrative Complexity Among Suicide Deaths in the National Violent Death Reporting System (2003–2021 NVDRS)”. In: *Information* 16.11 (2025). ISSN: 2078-2489. DOI: 10.3390/info16110989. URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/2078-2489/16/11/989>.
- [3] Alexander Johnson, **Christina Chance**, Kaycee Stiemke, Hariram Veeramani, Natarajan Balaji Shankar, and Abeer Alwan. “An Analysis of Large Language Models for African American English Speaking Children’s Oral Language Assessment”. In: *Journal of Black Excellence in Engineering, Science, Technology* 1 (Dec. 2023). DOI: 10.65465/PFZC5664.

Conference Publications

- [4] **Christina Chance** and Jennifer Healey. “Surprising Personas: Persona Sets with Controllably Unexpected Features”. In: *Proceedings of the Extended Abstracts of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. CHI EA ’26. Association for Computing Machinery, 2026. ISBN: 9798400722813. DOI: 10.1145/3772363.3798969. URL: <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772363.3798969>.
- [5] Rachita Rajesh, **Christina Chance**, Ashmia Suvarna, Kai-Wei Chang, and Saadia Gabriel. *No Convo! The Illusion of Reliability in Online Toxicity Detection*. 2026.
- [6] **Christina Chance** and Kai-Wei Chang. “Re-imagining Virtual Communities: Ethical Guidelines for Studying Black Twitter”. In: *Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society* 8.1 (Oct. 2025), pp. 541–553. DOI: 10.1609/aies.v8i1.36569. URL: <https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AIES/article/view/36569>.
- [7] Haniyeh Ehsani Oskouie, **Christina Chance**, Claire Huang, Margaret Capetz, Elizabeth Eyeson, and Majid Sarrafzadeh. “Leveraging Large Language Models and Topic Modeling for Toxicity Classification”. In: *2025 International Conference on Computing, Networking and Communications (ICNC)*. 2025, pp. 123–127. DOI: 10.1109/ICNC64010.2025.10994061.
- [8] Ashima Suvarna, **Christina Chance**, Karolina Naranjo, Hamid Palangi, Sophie Hao, Thomas Hartvigsen, and Saadia Gabriel. “ModelCitizens: Representing Community Voices in Online Safety”. In: *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. Ed. by Christos Christodoulopoulos, Tanmoy Chakraborty, Carolyn Rose, and Violet Peng. Suzhou, China: Association for Computational Linguistics, Nov. 2025, pp. 30850–30866. ISBN: 979-8-89176-332-6. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2025.emnlp-main.1571. URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2025.emnlp-main.1571/>.
- [9] Natarajan Balaji Shankar, Alexander Johnson, **Christina Chance**, Hariram Veeramani, and Abeer Alwan. “CORAL QA: A Dataset and Framework for Open Domain Spontaneous Speech Question Answering from Long Audio Files”. In: *ICASSP 2024 - 2024 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2024, pp. 13371–13375. DOI: 10.1109/ICASSP48485.2024.10447109.

Workshop & Preprints

- [10] **Christina Chance**, Rebecca Pattichis, Arjun Subramonian, James He, Shruti Narayanan, Saadia Gabriel, and Kai-Wei Chang. *IYKYK (But AI Doesn't): Automated Content Moderation Does Not Capture Communities' Heterogeneous Attitudes Towards Reclaimed Language*. 2026. arXiv: 2604.16654 [cs.CL]. URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.16654>.
- [11] **Christina Chance**, Da Yin, Dakuo Wang, and Kai-Wei Chang. “Will the Prince Get True Love’s Kiss? On the Model Sensitivity to Gender Perturbation over Fairytale Texts”. In: *Proceedings of the 5th Workshop on Trustworthy NLP (TrustNLP 2025)*. Ed. by Trista Cao, Anubrata Das, Tharindu Kumarage, Yixin Wan, Satyapriya Krishna, Ninareh Mehrabi, Jwala Dhamala, Anil Ramakrishna, Aram Galystan, Anoop Kumar, Rahul Gupta, and Kai-Wei Chang. Albuquerque, New Mexico: Association for Computational Linguistics, May 2025, pp. 444–460. ISBN: 979-8-89176-233-6. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2025.trustnlp-main.29. URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2025.trustnlp-main.29/>.
- [12] Rebecca Dorn, **Christina Chance**, Casandra Rusti, Charles Bickham Jr., Kai-Wei Chang, Fred Morstatter, and Kristina Lerman. *Reinforcing Stereotypes of Anger: Emotion AI on African American Vernacular English*. 2025. arXiv: 2511.10846 [cs.CL]. URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2511.10846>.
- [13] Avalon Vinella, Margaret Capetz, Rebecca Pattichis, **Christina Chance**, Reshmi Ghosh, and Kai-Wei Chang. *Leveraging Language Models to Detect Greenwashing*. 2024. arXiv: 2311.01469 [cs.CL]. URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2311.01469>.
- [14] Yixin Wan, Arjun Subramonian, Anaelia Ovalle, Zongyu Lin, Ashima Suvarna, **Christina Chance**, Hritik Bansal, Rebecca Pattichis, and Kai-Wei Chang. *Survey of Bias In Text-to-Image Generation: Definition, Evaluation, and Mitigation*. 2024. arXiv: 2404.01030 [cs.CV]. URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.01030>.

Thesis & Others

- [15] **Christina Chance**, Grace Sosa, Kai-Wei Chang, and Terence Keel. *Can LLMs Annotate Carceral Death Records? A Case Study in Automated Information Extraction from Forensic Autopsy Reports*. <https://openreview.net/forum?id=ktsqwIqw7P>. Seventh Workshop on Natural Language Processing and Computational Social Science (Non-archival). 2026.
- [16] **Christina Chance**. “Operationalizing Harm, Designing Support: Toward a Community-Centered Framework for Moderation and Fairness”. MA thesis. Los Angeles, CA: University of California Los Angeles, May 2025.
- [17] **Christina Chance**. “Zoom Audio Transcription Accuracy for African American Vernacular English”. Bachelors thesis. Atlanta, GA: Emory University, 2022.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Collegium of University Teaching Fellows (CUTF)**, UCLA, 2026–2027
 - Designing and teaching an original undergraduate writing course, “AI, Power, and Society,” offered for writing credit, on how AI systems exercise and reshape social and political power.
 - Drawing on social computing and digital ethnography, students learn to synthesize information across fields and apply NLP approaches to study the implications of these tools for social and political power.
- **UCLA TA Coordinator** (Appointed Year-Long), 2025–2026 & 2026–2027
 - Year-long departmental appointment overseeing, mentoring, and supporting computer science teaching assistants, coordinating TA assignments and training.
 - Served as a liaison between TAs, instructors, and the department.
- **Teaching Assistant**, UCLA CS495 (TA Training Seminar), Fall 2025 & 2026 — Prof. Sandra Batista. Supported ~75 students; graded assignments, provided feedback to new TAs, hosted office hours.
- **Teaching Assistant**, UCLA CS32 (Introduction to Computer Science II), Summer 2026 — Prof. Bruce Huang. Supported ~180 students; led discussion sections, hosted office hours, and assisted in grading exams.
- **Teaching Assistant**, UCLA CS131 (Programming Languages), Winter 2025 & Spring 2025 — Prof. Paul Eggert. Led weekly discussion sections and managed exams for ~120–180 students across two terms.
- **Ignite Fellow**, Teach for America, 2025
 - Selective fellowship placing fellows as virtual tutors and mentors for K-12 students in under-resourced schools, delivering supplemental instruction in core subjects.

- **Teaching Assistant**, UCLA CS180 (Introduction to Algorithms and Complexity), Fall 2024 — Prof. Alexis Korb & Prof. Glenn Reinman. Supported ~240 students; led discussion sections and hosted office hours.
- **Teaching Assistant**, UCLA CS263 & CS162 (Natural Language Processing), Spring & Winter 2024 — Prof. Nanyun Peng. Helped create and grade assignments, exams, and course projects across ~120–130 students per term.
- **Teaching Assistant**, UCLA CS30 (Principles and Practices of Computing), Fall 2023 — Prof. Todd Millstein. Supported ~120 students.
- **Teaching Assistant**, Emory University CS377 (Database Systems), Spring 2022 — Prof. Nosayba El-Sayed. Supported ~40 students.

INVITED TALKS & GUEST LECTURES

- **Invited Talk**, Wilfandel Club House, Los Angeles, 2026. “Black Futures in the Age of Artificial Intelligence: A Fireside Chat on AI, Innovation, Equity, & Community” Community talk to an audience of Black women on how emerging AI systems affect Black communities.
- **Guest Lecture**, Anthro 259: Ethnography in Technology, UCLA, 2026. On the failure modes of large language models that disproportionately affect marginalized communities and their relation to content moderation.
- **Guest Instructor**, Hartford Youth Scholars, 2026. Designed and taught “Introduction to Computational Art,” a short introductory course for middle school students.
- **Invited Talk**, MARS Lab (Prof. Saadia Gabriel), UCLA, 2024. Presented preliminary work on IYKYK and on bias in AAVE emotion detection, alongside an overview of related research.
- **Invited Talk**, USC ISI Fairness and Bias Seminar, 2024. Presented preliminary findings from IYKYK.

SERVICE

- Program Committee/Reviewer: AIES 2025, 2026; FAccT 2026; ARR Feb. 2025; TrustNLP 2025
- UCLA Student Conduct Committee Member, 2024–Present
 - Sit on panels reviewing student conduct cases and deciding whether a student has violated the code of conduct.
- UCLA Student Fee Advisory Committee (SFAC) Member 2024–2026 & Chair 2026–Present
 - Student-majority committee recognized by Regents Policy 3101 that advises the Chancellor on allocating the Student Services Fee across student-facing units and programs.
 - Oversee a roughly \$2M student fee budget, review unit usage of student fee funds through unit reviews, and make recommendations on course material fees, referenda, and other campus fees.
- Computer Science Graduate Students Association at UCLA Executive Board Member, 2024–Present.
- Graduate Women in Computer Science at UCLA Treasurer & Executive Board Member, 2022–Present.
- Black Graduate Student Alliance at UCLA Historian & Treasurer, 2022–Present.
- Grad STRIVE 2.0 Grad2Grad Mentor, 2024–2025.
- ACM FAccT 2024 Craft Organizer of In Código of Hope: Possibilities of Global Solidarity and Activism in Academic Environments.
- UCLA Computer Science Summer Institute 2024 Introductory & Intermediate Program Coordinator.
- NAACL TrustNLP 2024 Program Committee.
- Institute for African-American Mentoring in Computing Sciences Mentor, 2023–2024.
- ACM SIGKDD KDD 2023 Equity, Diversity, Inclusion Day Workshop Co-Organizer and Panelist.
- ACM FAccT 2023 Volunteer.

- Black & Latinx in STEM (BLIS) at Emory University, Co-Founder and President, 2019–2022
 - Created a space for Black and brown STEM students to build community, learn about research opportunities, receive mentorship, and explore careers in the field.
 - Partnered with the undergraduate research program and IMSD, and established a faculty mentorship board that advocated for the organization and its students.

AWARDS

- FAccT 2026 Doctoral Consortium. *Selected participant in the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency doctoral consortium.*
- Outstanding Mentorship Award (Graduate Student), awarded by UCLA Computer Science 2026.
- GEM Fellow, awarded 2025 (\$16k). *Nationally competitive fellowship supporting underrepresented minority students in STEM PhD programs.*
- Eugene V. Cota-Robles Fellow, awarded by UCLA 2022–27 (\$60k across 2 AY). *Prestigious university-wide fellowship awarded to exceptional doctoral students from underrepresented backgrounds.*
- 100 Senior Honorary, awarded by Emory University 2022. *Recognizes the top 100 graduating seniors for academic and leadership excellence.*
- Computer Science Outstanding Student of the Year, awarded by Emory University 2022.

SKILLS

Programming	Python (advanced) SQL, Java (proficient) R, PHP, MATLAB, HTML (basic)
--------------------	---